

# ANDES TO AMAZON

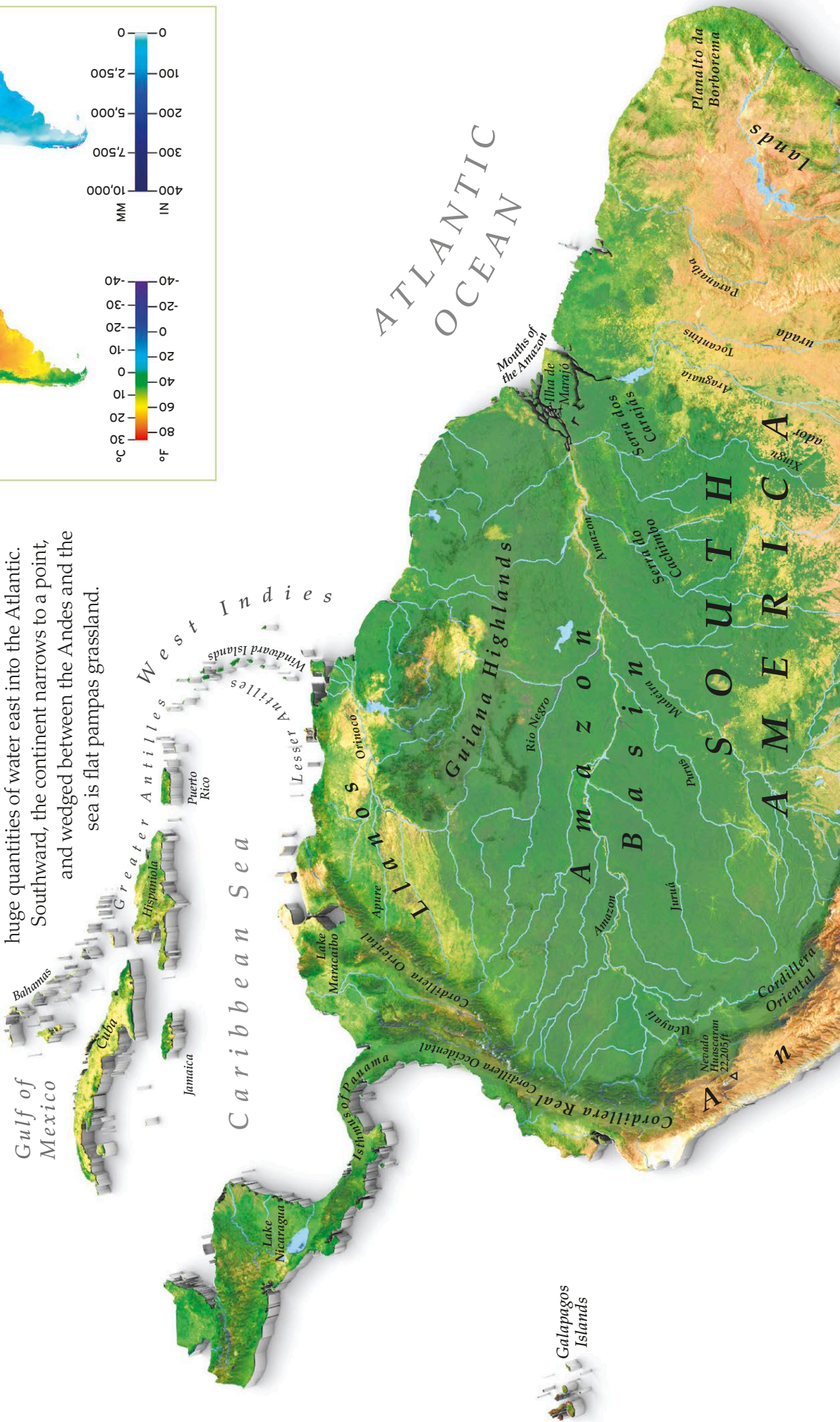
## Central and South America

South America is roughly triangular in shape, with a curved hook of land at either end: the narrow neck known as the Isthmus of Panama in the north; and the aptly named Cape Horn and the islands of Tierra del Fuego in the south.

The soaring Andes mountains, South America's sturdy spine, extend 4,500 miles (7,200 km) down

the continent's western edge, making them the world's longest mountain range by far. They are also the second highest, after the Himalayas, and are crowned by the 22,838 ft (6,961 m) peak of Aconcagua in Argentina. To the northeast, high plateaus rise above the vast, dense tropical rain forests, which are watered by the mighty Amazon River and its tributaries—together, they carry huge quantities of water east into the Atlantic.

Southward, the continent narrows to a point, and wedged between the Andes and the sea is flat pampas grassland.



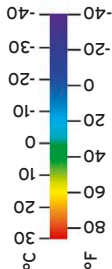
### KEY DATA

- Highest point** Aconcagua, Argentina: 22,838 ft (6,961 m)
- Lowest point** Laguna del Carbón, Argentina: -344 ft (-105 m)
- Hottest record** Rivadavia, Argentina: 120°F (49°C)
- Cooldest record** Sarmiento, Argentina: -27°F (-33°C)

### CLIMATE

Much of Central and South America lies within the tropics, but the south extends close to icy Antarctica. The Amazon forests are warm and moist, but plateaus in the mountains are dry.

#### AVERAGE TEMPERATURE



#### AVERAGE RAINFALL

